

Stand-by Time

The duration you can leave your fully charged phone on, before the battery dies out. Check out similarly used jargon at <http://bit.ly/8XPb6F>

Important buying factors

Before you buy a laptop, read important advice at <http://bit.ly/aeVmVN>

Consumer Support

the handset. Although that may sound surprising, we must ensure none of the steps we take are detrimental to our course to justice. Unaware of the proper course to be followed, Srirengam gave it all away because of haste. Consumermate.com has an informative guide to your safety as a consumer.

Go to www.tinyurl.com/digit-protect to read some really valuable tips. For example, point 2 of the checklist states, in case any defect/deficiency is detected in the product, first you should approach the seller and preferably submit the complaint in writing giving complete details. In case the seller agrees to rectify the problem to your satisfaction, ask for time it should take to do the same and have a copy of acknowledgement of receipt of complaint for your records. If the seller fails to attend the complaint in due course of time or creates dispute, the buyer can approach Consumer Court, MRTP commission, Weight and Measurement Department, or file criminal complaint in case of cheating. Now a days, consumer courts are very effective in helping the consumer resolve disputes.

If only Srirengam had followed these words of advice, he would have been assured of a solution from Nokia. Today, although his would be a genuine case of injustice, there is nothing he can do to get a replacement or a service

because all warranties and guarantees absolve companies from any obligation if the end user tampers with the equipment, in this case a mobile phone. The fact is although Srirengam himself didn't open the mobile phone, he did in fact go to the local mobile repairer expecting a miracle to happen. Be wise, and keep your side of the case strong from the very beginning. In fact, save all documentation and receipt from the day you purchase your product.

It is a universally accepted fact – quality does cost money. When you pay a higher price, you have a right to demand better quality and service. Similarly, when you take the cheaper way out, you'll find yourself sooner or later calling out for help with no one obliged to help you. If buying your next mobile phone costs you marginally more to get you a receipt, go for it. The same bill will be your first documentation that you could present in your legal battle should there be a malfunction as Srirengam experienced.

Case File #48

A surprising victim this month was Digit's Michael Browne. We're all consumers after all. He has been using broadband services by Reliance Communications. As a customer, he says he's pleased with their network. Technically, they satisfying. But as a service, he didn't

seem very content. Maintaining a neutral stand here, we got in touch with Reliance Communications. Never for once did we mention that Michael Browne is an employee of 99 Media or Digit.

We presented his case as a reader of Digit, in the same way we represent you. It started on March 07, 2010 when a franchisee agent went to Browne's residence to check on his newly installed connection and since "he happened to meet him" also collect the bill amount of Rs. 800. Not sensing any foul-play, Browne handed him the amount and continued his normal schedule of online gaming and streaming music. A couple of days later while in office, he received a call stating his services have been discontinued because he hasn't made the necessary payments. Most of April passed without Internet services and he was levied an additional bill for the month along with the outstanding of Rs. 800 mentioned earlier.

Here he was, paying money, then charged for it again, and levied with normal billing despite termination of all services. We could see the frustration building within him. We decided to follow it up for him, without any bias. We presented the case as we saw it. We got in touch with the Corporate Communications department of Reliance Communications. Anuj Bakshi was the spokesperson who was in touch with



Saha's excited about his brand new monitor

us. He said, "this is a one-off case where due to an error somewhere in the flow, things get out of hand. However, we'll do our internal investigation and find out about the same. Since we are certain about the credentials of the customer and know it is not a wrongful denial of payment, we've made the necessary modifications to the database."

That sounded reassuring. His net was up and running in a couple of hours, and Browne was happy. There were frustrating hiccups again. The net was disconnected again and he was receiving calls saying his earlier request for disconnecting service was finally closed. Overall, it was a state of absolute confusion where one executive didn't know what the other was talking. Once we initiated communication with Reliance, Browne was even asked about some other Reliance services he had subscribed to in the past! Everything is now at ease with him enjoying the luxury of a fast broadband connection in the comfort of his home. **d**

This content is brought to you by



If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com